IELTS ACADEMIC · RESTRICTED STAFF MATERIAL

IELTS Academic Set 30

PRIVATE STAFF answer key and Listening transcript

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Answer keys and Listening transcripts are restricted to staff.

Listening

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	wood burner	woodburner
2	Mornington	
3	hardwood	
4	hall cupboard	
5	17 November	17th November, November 17, November 17th, 17th of November
6	secure link	
7	B	
8	A	
9	B	
10	C	
11	A	
12	C	
13	F	
14	H	
15	E	
16	B	
17	E	
18	A	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
19	D	
20	C	
21	B	
22	A	
23	C	
24	B	
25	B	
26	home plan	
27	self-correction	self correction
28	20 minutes	twenty minutes
29	communication method	
30	second-year students	second year students
31	shell	
32	moisture conditions	
33	five centimetres	5 centimetres, 5 cm, 5cm, five centimeters, 5 centimeters, five cm
34	100	one hundred
35	modern	
36	water-table depth	water table depth
37	B	
38	E	
39	D	
40	A	

Listening transcript

Part 1 - Everyday social dialogue: arranging a domestic chimney inspection in Dunedin, New Zealand

Jasper Tait	Good morning, Otago Hearth Inspections. Jasper speaking. How can I help today?
Mireille Corbin	Hello. I would like to book the annual inspection for the heater in my house well before next winter, when we will use it regularly.
Jasper Tait	Certainly. Is the appliance an open fireplace, an enclosed insert, or a freestanding wood burner?

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Mireille Corbin	It is a freestanding wood burner. The previous owner called it a stove, but it stands clear of the brick wall rather than sitting inside a fireplace.
Jasper Tait	Thanks. What suburb should I put on the booking? We group appointments by area so the inspector is not crossing the city repeatedly.
Mireille Corbin	Mornington. The street address is twelve Lorne Street, but Mornington is the suburb you need for the route.
Jasper Tait	And what fuel do you normally burn? Some households mix manufactured logs with ordinary firewood.
Mireille Corbin	We tried manufactured logs once, then stopped. We now use dry hardwood, stored under cover, so please record hardwood as the main fuel.
Jasper Tait	The inspector may need to examine the flue from inside the roof space. Where is the access hatch?
Mireille Corbin	It is inside the hall cupboard. Someone suggested moving it to the laundry, but that work never happened, so the hall cupboard is still correct.
Jasper Tait	I can offer Monday the seventeenth of November at nine thirty, or Wednesday the nineteenth after lunch.
Mireille Corbin	Wednesday clashes with work. Let us take 17 November at nine thirty, please.
Jasper Tait	Afterwards we can post a printed certificate, send an ordinary email attachment, or place the signed report behind a secure link.
Mireille Corbin	A secure link would be best. Our insurer accepts the signed digital version, and I would rather not have the report sitting in an unprotected email.
Jasper Tait	That completes the booking details. I will now explain what the standard visit covers and what you should do before we arrive.
Jasper Tait	We begin with a visual check of the appliance, hearth, visible joints and accessible flue sections. An inspection camera is not used automatically.
Mireille Corbin	I wondered whether I should pay for the camera now because a bird once nested near the chimney.
Jasper Tait	Not yet. If the visual check suggests a blockage or hidden damage, the inspector will discuss the camera with you before adding it. That avoids an unnecessary charge.
Mireille Corbin	Why is the morning appointment longer than the afternoon slot I saw online?
Jasper Tait	It is not longer. We chose morning because the burner must be completely cold, and an early visit makes that easier after an overnight shutdown.
Mireille Corbin	I saw both a brief condition note and a detailed compliance certificate on the website. Which one have I actually booked?
Jasper Tait	The detailed certificate. The brief note is for landlords who only want a visible-condition record; your insurer asked for measurements and photographs as well.
Mireille Corbin	Is there anything I should move before the inspector arrives?
Jasper Tait	Please clear the hall cupboard so the roof hatch opens fully. Leave the heavy stove in place, remove loose ash only when cold, and keep pets away from the work area.

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Mireille Corbin	Fine. The burner will be cold, the cupboard will be clear, and I will use the secure link when the detailed certificate is ready.
Jasper Tait	Perfect. You will receive a reminder the day before. If the weather prevents a safe roof check, we will contact you rather than leave an incomplete certificate.

Part 2 - Everyday social monologue: induction to a shared ceramics studio in Perth, Australia

Bronte Hales	Welcome to Harbour Clay Studio. I am Bronte Hales, the coordinator. Keep the plan in front of you while I explain how the rooms connect and where equipment is located.
Bronte Hales	North is at the top. You entered through the main door on the southern wall. Reception is immediately to your right, and the broad clean walkway runs straight north from the entrance.
Bronte Hales	The wash-up sink is fixed on the western wall, halfway along the building. Opposite it, on the eastern wall, is the first-aid point. These are useful anchors when the studio is busy.
Bronte Hales	The clay store is in the enclosed north-west corner, beyond the wash-up sink and against both the north and west walls.
Bronte Hales	Do not confuse it with the open reclaim bay immediately south of the sink. Unopened bags of clay are kept behind the corner-room door.
Bronte Hales	From the entrance, walk north along the clean walkway and turn left before the central worktables. The pottery wheels occupy the western side beside those tables.
Bronte Hales	The space closer to reception contains lockers, not wheels. The wheel area is the one farther north, where the floor is prepared for wet work.
Bronte Hales	The glaze bench is on the eastern wall, directly south of the first-aid point. The counter immediately beside reception is only for collecting finished work.
Bronte Hales	Continue to the fire door in the north-east corner. The kiln room is on the far side of that door. A ventilated mixing alcove lies before the door.
Bronte Hales	Finally, the drying racks stand just north of the central worktables and west of the clean walkway. They are open shelves rather than an enclosed room.
Bronte Hales	The central aisle must stay clear, including during classes. Trolleys can cross it briefly, but they cannot be parked there because it is our direct route to the emergency exit.
Bronte Hales	You now know the working layout. I will go through one operating rule for each main facility, beginning with the reclaim bay.
Bronte Hales	At clay reclaim, keep scraps damp. Dry sweeping can put fine dust into the air, so use the wet-cleaning tools stored by the sink and close the reclaim tub after use.
Bronte Hales	At the glaze bench, food and drink are not allowed. A covered water bottle may stay in your locker, but it should not be placed on a surface used for glaze materials.
Bronte Hales	The kiln room is restricted to trained staff. Members may leave labelled work on the loading shelf, yet they must not enter to adjust a firing schedule or open a hot kiln.
Bronte Hales	At the pottery wheels, operate the floor pedal only while seated securely. Switch the wheel off before changing a bat or reaching underneath to retrieve a tool.
Bronte Hales	Every piece placed on the drying racks needs the owner’s name and the date. The date helps us move work fairly when shelf space is limited.

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Bronte Hales	If a spill occurs, tell the duty technician. A wet clay spill can usually be contained quickly, but powdered materials require the studio's specific clean-up procedure.
Bronte Hales	Finished glazed pieces appear on the collection counter after cooling and inspection. Check the matching shelf number rather than moving another member's work to search for yours.
Bronte Hales	Children may attend the weekend hand-building class, but the wheel area and kiln room remain outside that programme. A tutor will show families their assigned tables.
Bronte Hales	Before leaving, wipe your table with the damp cloth provided, return shared tools, and wash your hands. The final person in each class checks that the clean walkway is empty.
Bronte Hales	That concludes the induction. Ask a member of studio staff if you are uncertain, and leave the clean walkway clear when you go.

Part 3 - Educational discussion: nursing students refine a teach-back simulation study in Belfast

Sorcha Venn	Our first proposal compares standard discharge instructions with teach-back, but the tutor said we had not controlled the consultations closely enough.
Ivor Quade	The obvious solution is to use simulation actors. Real patients would be more authentic, although their diagnoses, questions and prior knowledge would vary too much for this small study.
Sorcha Venn	So the main reason for actors is consistency. Each participant can receive the same fictional case and the same initial information before the communication method changes.
Ivor Quade	Exactly. The actors should use a standard prompt sheet, but respond naturally if a student asks a sensible follow-up question.
Sorcha Venn	What should our primary outcome be? Satisfaction is easy to collect, and confidence sounds attractive, but neither shows whether the message was understood.
Ivor Quade	Let us score recall of the warning signs and the follow-up action. Those details matter in the fictional discharge plan and can be checked against a clear rubric.
Sorcha Venn	Agreed. We can keep satisfaction as a secondary measure. It may explain whether students find teach-back awkward, but it should not replace the recall score.
Ivor Quade	For allocation, I originally placed the morning group in the standard condition and the afternoon group in teach-back. That would be simple to organise.
Sorcha Venn	It would also mix the teaching time with the method. We should randomise within each session, using sealed cards prepared before participants arrive.
Ivor Quade	Yes, within-session randomisation is fairer. We will keep equal numbers where possible and record any participant who withdraws before the simulation begins.
Sorcha Venn	Do we need video? It would show eye contact and gestures, but the rubric focuses on spoken explanations and patient responses.
Ivor Quade	Audio is sufficient and less intrusive. More importantly, a second assessor can code a sample of recordings, so we can estimate whether the rubric is applied consistently.
Sorcha Venn	Then the recording is mainly for checking coding reliability, not for producing presentation clips. We should say that clearly in the participant information.
Ivor Quade	Then we will compare our scores before recruitment starts. If the two coders interpret a category differently, the rubric needs clarification rather than an averaged compromise.

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Ivor Quade	The pilot consultation lasted nearly twenty minutes because the discharge script contained six medicines and several unrelated lifestyle points.
Sorcha Venn	That is too crowded. A shorter case with two medicines, one warning sign and one follow-up appointment would leave enough room for genuine explanation.
Ivor Quade	So the key pilot change is to shorten the case, rather than asking actors to speak faster. The communication method should remain the feature we are comparing.
Sorcha Venn	We also need to define what the actor says after the student gives the discharge explanation. A vague request such as repeat that could produce very different responses.
Ivor Quade	A better prompt is: tell me your home plan. That invites the actor to explain what they will do without copying the student's exact wording.
Sorcha Venn	The rubric should credit accurate content even when the actor pauses and corrects an initial mistake. We can add a self-correction category instead of scoring only the first response.
Ivor Quade	Good. That separates a final misunderstanding from a mistake the actor recognises and repairs after thinking.
Sorcha Venn	Immediate recall might exaggerate performance because the explanation is still fresh. How long can we wait without making the session impractical?
Ivor Quade	Twenty minutes is manageable. Participants can complete the satisfaction form during the interval, but they must not see the discharge sheet again.
Sorcha Venn	On the coding sheet, the category hidden from the recall assessor is labelled communication method. This prevents expectations from influencing the judgement.
Ivor Quade	We can remove the opening section of each recording and label every file with a neutral code. The remaining audio can be scored without revealing which version was assigned to that student.
Sorcha Venn	We should exclude anyone who helped design the fictional case, because they would know the intended details before the consultation.
Sorcha Venn	Who should we recruit? First-year students have little placement experience, while final-year students may already use teach-back routinely.
Ivor Quade	Second-year students offer a useful middle point. They have practised discharge conversations, yet the technique is unlikely to be automatic.
Ivor Quade	That gives us a manageable protocol. We will revise the documents tonight, test the materials with two volunteers on Thursday, and resolve any practical problems before participant recruitment begins next week.

Part 4 - Academic monologue: reconstructing peatland water tables with testate amoebae in Edinburgh

Dr Elspeth Rennie	Today I will introduce testate amoebae as one line of evidence for reconstructing past peatland moisture. These are microscopic single-celled organisms that form a durable outer covering.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	When an organism dies, its soft tissues decay, but the shell can remain in peat. Identification therefore relies on durable structures rather than the living cell itself.

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Dr Elspeth Rennie	Different species tolerate different moisture conditions. Some are common where the water table lies close to the surface; others occur more often in comparatively dry microhabitats.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	A sample contains an assemblage, not a single perfect indicator. Researchers interpret the relative abundance of several taxa because one shell may have moved, broken or been misidentified.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	Fieldwork begins with a peat core taken through the accumulated deposit. The core preserves a vertical sequence, with recent material near the top and older material below, provided disturbance is recognised.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	In the cited peat-core study, testate-amoeba samples were taken every five centimetres. This spacing belongs to that proxy workflow and should not be confused with the denser schedule used for other evidence.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	Each testate-amoeba sample was prepared so the shells could be examined under a microscope. The analyst recorded enough individuals to describe the assemblage rather than reporting the first few seen.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	In the cited peat-core method, analysts used a light microscope and aimed to count a minimum of 100 tests in each sample whenever possible.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	Counts from an old core cannot by themselves provide water depth. Researchers first need reference data from present-day peat surfaces where both assemblages and current hydrological conditions are measured.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	That modern calibration links changes in community composition with observed water-table depth. Statistical relationships summarise the pattern across many modern samples, not just one convenient site.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	A transfer function applies the modern relationship to fossil assemblages. Its output is an estimate of past water-table depth, often accompanied by an uncertainty range.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	The estimate is not a direct measurement from the past. It assumes that the ecological relationship captured by the calibration remains informative for the older community.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	Now consider the sequence as a whole. A sustained shift towards moisture-associated taxa may suggest a higher local water table, while a brief change in one poorly counted sample deserves caution.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	Testate amoebae mainly inform us about conditions at or near the peat surface. They are therefore valuable indicators of local water-table position, but they do not describe every process around the bog.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	Transfer functions have limitations. A fossil sample may contain a combination unlike the modern training set, so a numerical result can appear precise while resting on a weak analogue. Researchers should report analogue quality instead of allowing a smooth graph to conceal this weakness.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	Taxonomic decisions matter too. Two analysts may divide a variable group differently, and damaged shells sometimes remove the very features used for identification. Counting effort must also be recorded because a small total exaggerates the influence of uncommon taxa.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	Independent evidence can reveal whether an apparent moisture shift forms part of a broader environmental change. The comparison works only if each proxy is interpreted at the scale it actually represents. Agreement is informative, while disagreement can expose a mistaken chronology or an overly simple ecological explanation.

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Dr Elspeth Rennie	Pollen is a classical proxy that directly identifies vegetation shifts. It provides a different line of evidence from the testate-amoeba reconstruction, so agreement between them can strengthen an interpretation without making the two records interchangeable.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	The study design also distinguishes the spacing of samples. Pollen, microscopic charcoal and testate amoebae were sampled at five-centimetre intervals, while other evidence was examined more continuously.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	Plant macrofossils and macroscopic charcoal were analysed continuously at one-centimetre intervals. That denser sequence can reveal short-lived changes that a wider interval might miss, although chronology is still required before any change is assigned an age.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	So, for plant macrofossils, the relevant feature here is continuous one-centimetre sampling. Do not confuse that method with the five-centimetre schedule used for pollen, microscopic charcoal and testate amoebae in the same study.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	The core chronology was built independently from dated material and an age-depth model. This matters because depth alone is not an exact calendar age: accumulation rates can vary, and a physical sequence must be dated before its ecological changes are placed in time.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	A second activated study used lipid biomarkers as chemical evidence. It compared peat from fixed depths in cores taken from natural, degraded and restored bogs, while keeping the conclusions bounded by the available sampling design.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	In that study, lipid biomarkers were used to assess peatland composition, decomposition and restoration success. The authors also warned that one core per site and only three sampled depths limited both spatial and vertical resolution.
Dr Elspeth Rennie	The general lesson is methodological restraint: combine biological and chemical proxies, preserve an explicit chronology, and report sampling limits instead of presenting a reconstruction as a direct measurement of the past.

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Reading

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	glass cover	
2	brine	
3	steel base	galvanised steel
4	absorber coating	Fe2O3
5	EPS insulation	expanded polystyrene, EPS
6	wooden panels	
7	1 m2	
8	30 cm	
9	36 degrees	
10	pyranometer	
11	thermocouples	K-type thermocouples
12	distilled water	
13	anemometer	
14	iii	
15	vi	
16	ii	
17	v	
18	iv	
19	i	
20	TRUE	
21	TRUE	
22	NOT GIVEN	
23	TRUE	
24	TRUE	
25	FALSE	
26	NOT GIVEN	
27	YES	
28	NO	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
29	NOT GIVEN	
30	YES	
31	YES	
32	B	
33	C	
34	B	
35	D	
36	A	
37	B	
38	C	
39	D	
40	D	

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